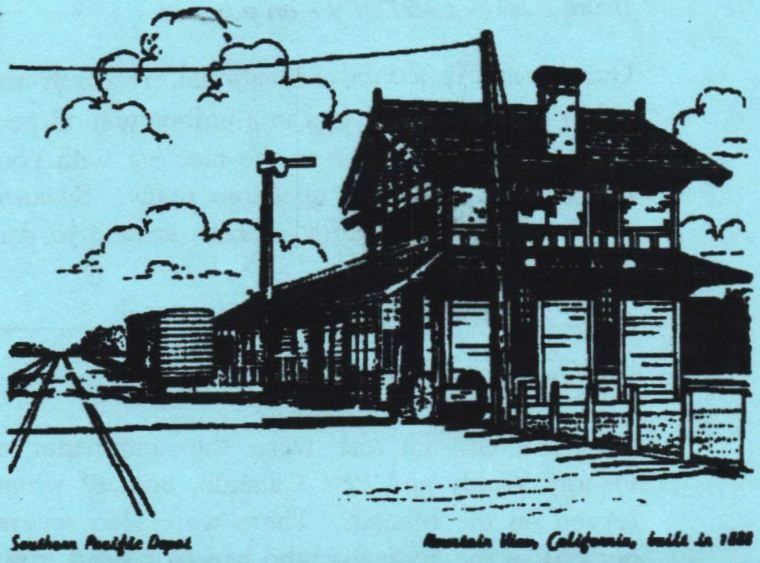
MOUNTAIN VIEW
HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION NEWSLETTER

P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042

Hilton U. Brown, III - Editor



THE MOUNTAIN VIEW LIBRARY
The February Meeting

The Mountain View Public Library has been an integral and vital part of the City of Mountain View since the very early days. Founded and endowed by a group of citizens, it prospered thru the support and efforts of many volunteers. Since it's incorporation into the City, it has had several homes, but it has continued to outgrow the facilities provided. A new library building is now under construction and should be ready for occupancy by the end of this year.

Our speaker on Sunday, February 2, will be Susan Ozubko, Mountain View's Library Services Director. She will review the history of the library, particularly as it relates to the people and organizations that "made it happen" over the years. She will describe the growth and problems which made the current expansion necessary, and will touch on some of the unique problems associated with building a new facility on the location of the old and in the vicinity of some of the City's most hollowed ground. She will end with describing something about the future of our library, and libraries in general.

(see - MV Library - on page 2)

LIFE AS A CREWMAN ON THE USS MACON
The November Meeting

The November meeting provided an unusual insight into what it was like to live aboard those great and beautiful airships. As the US Navy operated them, they were submarines of the air, complete with wheel, rudder, diving planes, and speaker tubes. Life aboard, even for the enlisted men, provided comfortable accommodations and good food. There were three crews, one flying, one doing maintenance and housekeeping and the third on break, and they normally rotated every 72 hours. When they were flying, they worked four hours on and four hours off, with hot bunking. (A single bunk alternated between two crewmen.) Accommodations were surprisingly spacious.

The Macon could make 75 knots, which doesn't seem fast in comparison with the airplanes, even of the thirties, but this ship was the size of a cruiser. The Macon carried a crew of more than eighty, and had five aircraft which it could launch and retrieve. It could carry eighty tons, and had an operational range of 7500 miles and normally stayed operational for 72 hours at a time.

(see - Macon - on page 2)

*(from - **MV Library** - on page 1)*

Our library is a vital educational, research and cultural asset. It belongs in a unique way to people of the area. Come to the meeting with your thoughts, opinions and questions ready. Susan is perhaps the best qualified person around to deal with them.

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*(from - **Macon** - on page 1)*

Of particular interest were the comments of George Weldy and Pete Calande, both of whom served on the Macon. There were also several persons in the audience who had first hand experiences with the Macon to relate.

Ben deBolt put together an entertaining and informative afternoon for us, and we are grateful. If you would like to delve further into the life and times of the great airships, the Pioneer Room on the fourth floor of City Hall has lots of information, and the Moffett Field Historical Society has even more.

EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE MEETING

The Mountain View Historical Association Executive Committee met on December 12, 1996, in the Pioneer Room. The Treasurer's Report and the Membership Report are presented elsewhere in this Newsletter. The Adobe Task Force reported that it had forwarded to the City Council a packet which included petitions and letters of support for preserving the Adobe. A six month extension for further work by the Task Force was granted by the Council.

A representative from the Whisman-Middlefield Neighborhood asked the Association for help in preparing a list of suitable street names for recommendation to the City Council in connection with the GTE development. The executive committee was pleased to participate in this activity.

MOUNTAIN VIEW LIBRARY FOUNDATION

One of the advantages of being a Newsletter Editor is that you can occasionally get on your soap box for a favorite cause. You may have noticed that I have taken an interest in the Mountain View Public Library, supporting bond issues, calling attention to construction activities, et cetera. Well, at the February 2 meeting you will have an opportunity to share in my enthusiasm.

The Mountain View Library Foundation is a new not for profit corporation. Its objectives are summarized in it mission statement.

MISSION STATEMENT

The purpose of the Mountain View Library Foundation is to raise money to benefit the Mountain View Public Library. Private gifts made through the Foundation are used to enhance library materials, facilities, and services by supplementing the library's public funding.

The MVLF was able to salvage some of the bricks used in the old library, and most of the carved wooden letters which were on the wall in the children's area. They will be available as mementoes in exchange for a fifty dollar donation to the MVLF. Each object will be accompanied by a certificate attesting to its provenance, and if you would like, an actual sheet of the blueprints for the new library. Since the objects have no real intrinsic value, and the MVLF is an IRS approved charitable organization, your donation will be tax deductible.

Stop by the display table and take a look! It may be just the thing to recall many fond memories of your visits to the old library.

SAVE THE ADOBE TASK FORCE

Mission Statement: *The mission of the "Save the Adobe" Task Force is to restore and preserve Mountain View's historic Adobe Building for use as a vital community resource.*

The Task Force continues to meet on a regular basis. On December 11, 1996, the task force reported to the Mountain View City Council on the results of its year long efforts to ascertain the level of public support for preserving the Adobe. Results so far have been encouraging, and the Council urged the Task Force to try to find non-public funding to participate in the seismic upgrade and renovation work. The Task Force has recruited some additional volunteers and is preparing to imbark on a campaign to enlist corporate and foundation support. The Task Force must report back to the Council with the results of this campaign within six months.

In the mean time, garnering additional public support is a prime objective. A presentation kit has been developed, and the Task Force can arrange for a 30 minute presentation on very short notice. To schedule a presentation to your group contact Wally Erichsen or Hilton Brown. The Task Force is also prepared to participate with displays at conventions or meetings.

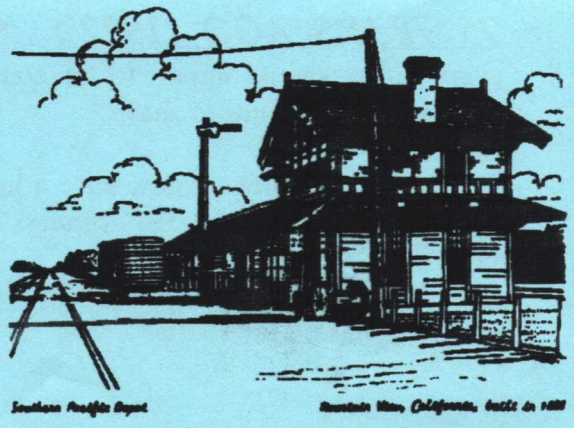
The Task Force welcomes your ideas and participation. If we are to preserve the Adobe, it will require the support of the entire community: individuals, small business, and corporations.

IN COMMEMORATION

James (Jim) Joseph Welch - in Mountain View, November 5, 1996. Born 1916 in San Jose. Retired school administrator who once taught at the Old Hiway School. He was the husband of the late Barbara de Curtoni Welch, a long time member of the Mtn. View Historical Association. They are survived by a son and daughter-in-law and two grandsons.

Antoinette (Ann) Marie Vidovich Taylor - in Los Altos, December 9, 1996. A Mtn. View native and 1933 graduate of Mountain View High School. An educator with degrees from both San Jose State University and Stanford University. A long time and active member of the Mountain View Historical Association.

Lorena Mylrea Anderson - in Stanford Hospital December 8, 1996. Age 78, born in Canada, she moved with her family to Mountain View at eight months. She attended local schools, graduating from Mtn. View High School in 1938. She is survived by her husband Lawrence E. Anderson, a former Mayor of Mountain View, and by her daughter and grandsons. She was a Life Member of the Mountain View Historical Association.



OLD NEWSPAPER ITEMS
Noted by Barbara Kinchen

100 YEARS AGO (1896): Two young boys were arrested for placing dynamite on the railroad tracks in Mountain View. Fortunately it was discovered and removed before a train arrived.

Mountain View Lodge AOUW (Ancient Order of United Workmen) was organized in 1879 and since that time has paid out $35,000 to widows and orphans of deceased members.

A 60-day sentence in the county jail was ordered by Frank Beverly, Justice of the Peace, for the man who stole the best hat from the schoolhouse "hat room" and left his battered one in its place. The constable caught up with him after an 18 mile chase.

Residents petitioned County Board of Supervisors to accept and maintain a road running parallel to the train tracks, from the Mountain View - Alviso Road, easterly, to Murphy's property line. It was to be called Evelyn Avenue and landowners were donating land for this two-mile road.

The school Board brought 1.54 acres at the corner of El Camino Real and Calderon Avenue, adjacent to the grammar school, for a high school. The land was cleared and fenced in preparation for building immediately. (It was not built until 1902.)

75 YEARS AGO (1922): "Knowledge every father should impart to his son: Learn to save before you learn to shave."

Pacific Press employees now have a lighted tennis court so they can play in the evenings.

Mountain View High School offers sewing and millinery classes for adults.

(continued in next column)

Pure, sweet, rich, non-pasteurized milk from Tuberculin-tested cows could be bought at Randall's Confectionery for 10¢ a quart.

Now being constructed: W.P. Angelo's factory on Stierlin Road to manufacture boxes and containers for holding berries and fruits; Growers' Ice and pre-Cooling Plant at Mariposa Avenue and the railroad tracks, where local berry growers would cool, ice and ship berries in refrigerated cars to all parts of the United States.

Neil Darrah, "the eminent Scotch baritone" now living in Mountain View, is offering free voice evaluations. Later he will teach classes and organize a choral group if there is enough interest.

Ernest Copp, Town Marshal, lives in comfortable apartments on the second floor of Town Hall, convenient as the jail is on the lower floor to the rear of the Public Library.

"Gloom is a carrion crow - shoot it."

50 YEARS AGO (1947): Bank of America moved into a new building at 301 Castro Street, now occupied by Printers Ink Book Store. Then, First National Bank moved from 200 Castro into the former B of A location, now the Red Rock Coffee Company spot.

Vandals have already damaged a number of the newly-installed parking meters. The city expects the meters to bring in a good income even though it costs 1¢ for 12 minutes or 5¢ per hour.

A small plane crashed at Rengstorff Avenue and Alma Street, now Central Expressway, while attempting a landing at Progressive Air Field on Middlefield Road near San Antonio Road. The pilot was killed and his passenger badly injured. This airport was formerly known as Mountain View Airport.

Anthony J. Radisich has opened a hardware store, Anrads, in a temporary barracks building, next to

*(see - **Old Newspapers** - on page 5)*

*(from - **Old Newspapers** - on page 4)*

the location on El Camino Real where a permanent store is to be constructed.

After serving for 20 years as City Court Judge and Judge of Fremont Township, James M. Atkinson retired to private law practice. Kenneth R. Malovos succeeded Atkinson.

Phil Evans opened his own butcher shop in Lawson's Grocery after 15 years with Safeway Stores.

A special census count showed that population of Mountain View had risen from 3,946 in 1940 to 5,803.

The Silver Seal Creamery was sold by Ormond and Helen Newfarmer to Al Lane, one of the Lane Creamery family.

25 YEARS AGO (1972)

Students at Bubb School are asking for the California desert tortoise be named the official state reptile.

North County Health and Welfare Services moved into the new building at 100 Moffett Boulevard and Central Expressway.

Residents voted down school tax increases for the second time in three months.

Planning commissioners recommended closing down all city wells and buying all water from San Francisco, to prevent further lowering of the water table and to insure a constant quality. Presently, one-third will water is used.

A candidate for City Council was arrested on marijuana charges and claimed it was a conspiracy to see that he would not be elected. He was found guilty and was sentenced to a term of 2 to 10 years.

(continued in next column)

The L.B. Nelson firm was approval for a $22 million shopping center on California Street near San Antonio Road, which will include theaters, shops, a bank, restaurants, offices, 300 apartments and a three-story water wheel. (The Old Mill complex.)

Planners have authorized 30 miles of paths and lanes for bikes, the first from Miramonte Avenue at the south city limits to the intersection of Stierlin and Middlefield Roads.

NEW TO THE PIONEER ROOM
Reported by Barbara Kinchen

From Jack and Betty (Lamica) Evans - Colored, 8x10", framed photo of the main entrance to the Mountain View High School on Castro Street.

From George Holden - Copy of Air & Space magazine for October/November 1966 containing an article, Going Vertical, about vertical-takeoff-and-landing fighter planes. One picture shows one of the planes being tested within the Moffett hangar.

From Sidney Glenn Freshour - Copy of his book, Wagons to Soquel, published 1995, about his Freshour family including references about the French and Conant connections in Mountain View.

Video tapes of the Mountain View Historical Association meetings, including the latest on ***Life on the Macon***, are available for checkout at the Pioneer Room. Carol Harris and Ben de Bolt have done a wonderful job on these videos.

THE MOUNTAIN VIEW MELTING POT

By Kathleen Lowe Owen

Today Mountain View is a virtual melting pot of people who have come here or have ancestors who came from various parts of the world. That was not true until fairly recently and at the end of the 19th century it was almost unheard of. For example, settlers from Japan did not arrive in Santa Clara County until 1898. At that time there were 12 Japanese residents - nine men and three women.

Records in the historical collection at the Mountain View Library show that many of the early Japanese settlers in Mountain View were men who worked at Minton's Lumber Yard. By 1912 there was an early Japanese school on the Minton's property where employees and their relatives could learn English.

In 1914 an elementary school which served the children of Japanese residents was established at Front (Evelyn) and View streets. There were perhaps five Japanese children in 1915 but by 1920 nearly 40 children attended this school. They were taught English, Japanese and the regular primary curriculum. The school was moved to the corner of Alma and Bailey at the Japanese Seventh Day Adventist Church. The Tri-City Association, which includes members from Sunnyvale and Los Altos, constructed a new Japanese School at View and Dana Streets. In 1929 the Mountain View Japanese Association incorporated this school, and eventually as many as 150 students attended on a regular basis.

That school was in operation until the start of World War II in 1941 when all people of Japanese ancestry were relocated to internment camps such as Hart Mountain and Nanzanar. During the war the building was leased to the Girl Scouts. In return the Girl Scouts were responsible for maintaining the property.

(continued in next column)

It wasn't until 1959 that the Japanese Language School was established. At that time the Tri-City Association of Sunnyvale, Los Altos and Mountain View, began sponsoring the school. Instead of offering a complete elementary education the school began to focus on the Japanese language and culture. It is still located at the Mountain View Buddhist Church on Shoreline Boulevard where as many as 100 students attend classes each Saturday. Though most students are of Japanese descent any student is welcome who has a desire to learn the Japanese language.

If you are interested in learning more about the different Japanese schools in Mountain View or in other information about our early Japanese residents you should visit the Historical Collection at Mountain View City Hall. A display of photographs as well as copies of oral histories compiled by some of Mountain View's residents is currently on display. The collection is open Tuesday, Wednesday and Thursday from 1PM until 5PM. Sunnyvale,

1997 DUES ARE DUE

Dues are now payable for 1997. If our records show your dues have not been paid for 1997 a remittance envelope is enclosed for your convenience. Members who have paid and have expired cards will receive a new membership card.

Dues are still $7.00 per person, $10.00 per family and Life Membership is $100.00 each. The same rates apply for new members or rejoining members. Dues pay for the cost of the Newsletter and Postage.

If you would like a complimentary Newsletter sent to a friend or have any questions please call me at 415-967-3116 and leave a message with my dog. Thank You. Edna Thompson

MEMBERSHIP REPORT

As of December 10, 1996

Reported by Edna Thompson

A list of members of the Mountain View Historical Association is available to members from the Chair of the Membership Committee. Dues are $7.00 per year for an individual or $10.00 per year for a family, and Life Membership is $100.00 per person.

Below is a tally by class of membership, and the names of new members.

Life Members	41
Special Members	2
Honored Member	1
Individual Members	159
Family Memberships	50
Total Memberships	253
Total Members	303

New Members (Since last Newsletter)

H. Craig and Majorie E. Holden
Pauline Gibson Bennett
Gretta Lowney

Life Members

Mario Ambra
Lawrence Anderson
Dena K. Bonnell
Reynolds Camp
Cliff Del Carlo
Ruth Erichsen
Wallace Erichsen
Carmen Farvelli
Ralph Faravelli
Roger Fellows
Patricia Figueroa
Marion Grimm
Estelle Stagg Heffelfinger
Bill Henderson
Eleanor McGlynn Henderson
Charles Hirschbek
DeWitt Hogle
Norene Hogle
George Holden
George Jagels
Al Jehning
Robert W. Kirby
Joe Kleitman
Helen Shearer Krogh
Holly Urban Moore Leonard
Kenneth Richard Malovos
Madeline Chargon Malovos
Eva Mockbee
Gail Urban Moore
Mimi Mourkas
Patricia J. Reyburn
Elaine Marcetti Shearer
Martin J. Spangler
Honor Spitz
Linda Swan
Joseph Sweeney
Roberta Sweeney
Edna Thompson
Sally Moore Taboada
John Viscovich
Bill Wissell

ASSOCIATION OFFICERS AND BOARD

President	Ralph Faravelli
Past President & Social	Wally Erichsen
Vice President	Arthur Walton
Secretary	Eva Mockbee
Treasurer	June de Larios
Membership	Edna Thompson
Newsletter & Program	Hilton Brown
Hospitality	Mary Esther Walton
Memorials/Rememberances	Edna Thompson
Ways & Means	Joseph Sweeney
Historical Data	Barbara Kinchen
Amplification & Recording	Albert Jehning

Regular meetings of the Mountain View Historical Association are held on the first Sunday of February, May, August and November. The Newsletter is mailed approximately two weeks before each meeting. Deadline for copy for the Newsletter is the third Sunday before each meeting. Short items on appropriate topics, submitted by any member of the Association will be considered for publication.

TREASURER'S REPORT

October 1, 1996 - December 31, 1996

Treasurer A.J. de Larios

Balance 10/1/96		$ 8,222.65
Income:		
Membership	$ 89.00	
Adobe Fund	774.00	
Interest	21.05	
Sales	80.00	
Total Income:		$ 964.05
Expenses:		
Adobe Fund	$ 133.48	
Administration	658.33	
Total Expenses:		791.81
Balance 12/31/96		$ 8,394.89
Fund Balances 12/31/96		
Adobe Fund	$ 2,304.56	
Memorial Fund	75.00	
Life Member Fund	4,100.00	
General Fund	1,915.33	
Total Fund Balances:		$ 8,394.89

MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

Regular Meeting

Sunday, February 8, 1996 - 2:00 PM

Senior Center - 266 Escuela

Topic and Speaker

The Mountain View Library

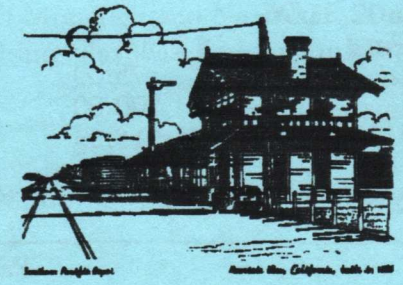
A Presentation By

Susan Ozubko

Library Services Director

Mountain View
Historical Association
P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042

FIRST CLASS MAIL



MEMBERSHIP

Any person who signifies interest in the aims of this Association and who pays the specified annual dues may become a member of the Association.

AIMS The aims of this Association are: To gather and preserve historical data relative to the early settlement and development of the area in and around the present City of Mountain View; to collect, record, edit and publish a history of the pioneering activities of this area; to preserve historic objects and places. To cooperate with other organizations in the Santa Clara Valley on projects deemed worthy by our membership.

MEMBERSHIP APPLICATION

NAME _____

ADDRESS _____

_____

TELEPHONE _____

NEW___RENEWAL___ Regular Membership $7.00/yr
Family Membership $10.00/yr - Life Membership $100.00
Make Check Payable and mail to:
Mountain View Historical Association
P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042